



File Code: 2360
Route To:

Date: November 3, 2023

Subject: Nebraska NF Heritage Program Report R2022020701042

To: District Ranger, Bessey Ranger District

Per stipulations outlined in the existing Programmatic Agreement (PA) between the Nebraska National Forests and Grasslands (NNFG) and the Nebraska State Historic Preservation Officer (SHPO), the following cultural resources inventory report has been submitted to the SHPO and the appropriate Tribal Historic Preservation Officers (THPOs):

An Intensive Cultural Resources Inventory of the Whitetail Road EA Project, Bessey Ranger District, Nebraska National Forests and Grasslands, Thomas and Blaine Counties, Nebraska,
USFS Report #R2022020701042

This project covers the new alignment for FR224, the closure of 1.2 miles of FR227, a temporary 4.3-acre material stockpile and staging area at the intersection of FR224 and FR227, and 220 feet of temporary fence line at the southern entrance to whitetail campground.

During the inventory, one new cultural resource (25TM76) was located within the project's Area of Potential Effect (APE). 25TM76 consists of a historic General Land Survey Office section marker which is not eligible for the NRHP. The project was determined to have "no historic properties affected." The Nebraska SHPO concurred with the determination of "No historic properties affected" on October 4th, 2023.

NHPA Section 106 compliance is complete. You now have cultural resources clearance to proceed with the project.

Please remember that the project will be temporarily stopped if bones, artifacts, or other indications of past human occupation are encountered during the project implementation. In that instance, the SHPO and interested Tribal Preservation programs will be consulted.

If project plans are changed, additional survey and review may need to occur.

If you have any questions, please contact Staff Archeologist, Casey Laughlin, at 308-432-0338 or casey.laughlin@usda.gov.

**JACK
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Forest Supervisor

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cc: Tom Emerson

